

Asymmetric Psychological Leverage

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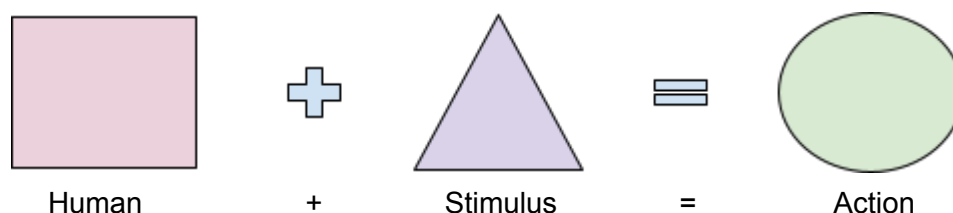
Introduction

Welcome to Asymmetric Psychological Leverage. This module explains how understanding Psychology can help us build successful client acquisition systems.

We'll be breaking down every core idea in Psychology under the sun (to do with client acquisition). If you want to create winning stimuli, **pay attention**.

Acquisition First Principles (Recap) 1 🏆

Let's start by revisiting where we started. Client Acquisition starts with a **human**.



Human (square): a **person** we want to attract as a client

Stimulus (triangle): a **stimulus** we use to get an **action** (getting someone to do something)

Action (circle): **human** **acting** in a way that supports them becoming a client

Client Acquisition is all about getting **humans** to take **action**. The process of converting a random stranger (**human**) into a client revolves around getting them to take a series of actions called a **micro-action-chain**.

Here's Imperium's **Micro-Action-Chain** for YouTube organic attraction for example:

clicking vid > watching vid > reading description > clicking link > watching video > believing social proof > clicking a button to schedule > selecting a time > providing qualifying information > watching interviews > showing up for call > agreeing to agenda > answering questions (15-20 mins) > listening to pitch > asking questions > raising objections > listening to rebuttals > being convinced > making a decision > clicking link to pay > filling out card information > pressing button to pay

A working **stimulus** is a **trigger** that **triggers** an action in the **micro-action-chain**. Acquiring clients is as simple as 'lining up' the **effective** **triggers** and exposing them to the human in a linear order. For example, from the above micro-action-chain, we can get the **stimuli-chain**:

thumbnail & title > hook & content > CTA in content > funnel link > funnel title > GIF thumbnail on video > compelling social proof > CTA in video & page to book > calendly interface > questions > thankyou page & email > stating agenda > asking questions > pitching product > staying silent > stating price > overcoming objections > closing > sending payment link > waiting for card info

Different stimuli are 'assigned' to get different actions. A Youtube thumbnail, for example, is assigned to get clicks. A funnel lead form is assigned to get email addresses.

Stimulus Effectiveness 💰 ➡ 📱

Anyone can list out micro-action & stimuli chains. Anyone can design stimuli. But that doesn't mean they're going to get results (\$\$\$).

You only get results (\$\$\$) when you have effective stimuli.

Effective: the word used to describe a stimulus that successfully triggers its assigned action.

Effectiveness isn't binary. A stimulus isn't simply 'effective' or 'ineffective', in regards to it triggering an action. Instead, we look at effectiveness as a spectrum.



100% Effectiveness: the metric the stimulus is attributed to is way above KPI

0.00% Effectiveness: the metric the stimulus is attributed to it way below KPI

Remember that more often than not, stimuli work in pairs, trios or quads (as key variables), so you could have a super effective stimulus, but if you pair it with an ineffective stimulus, it's effectiveness cancels out.

Example: *you can have the best YouTube thumbnail in the world, but if you have the worst video title in the world, the video won't get clicks.*

The premise here is simple: the more likely a stimulus is to trigger its assigned action, the more effective it is.

Now for the important questions:

What determines whether or not a stimulus has high effectiveness?

How do we know what creates a good stimulus?

How do we get people to take action with our stimuli?

The truth is that most people think it's luck. They're wrong.

The Human Component 🧑 🧑

Humans in your niche determine the effectiveness of a stimulus. They set the conditions for what is or is not effective.

What is a human?

Human = Body + Mind

Body: the physical being of a human, the shell they exist in, executes orders from the mind

Mind: the mental being of a human, thought & consciousness itself, gives orders to the body

The mind sets the action, and the body executes it.

If we want a human to take an action, (click, reply, schedule, open, answer), we need to get their body to execute it. For their body to execute it, we need to get their mind to set it.

Psychology is the study of the mind & the behaviour it produces.

The mind is split into two parts: the conscious mind, and the unconscious mind.

The mind can set actions consciously, or unconsciously.

95% of human decisions and actions happen unconsciously

- (Harvard Prof. Gerald Zaltman)

Think about it:

How conscious was your decision to eat what you ate this morning? Probably not very.

How conscious was your decision to drink the water you just drank? Probably not very.

How conscious was your decision to scroll through Facebook this morning, (or god forbid, now)?

How conscious was your decision to click on Imperium's funnel? Probably not very.

How conscious was your decision to agree to our sales agenda? Probably not very.



Humans make both decisions & actions in the client acquisition consciously and unconsciously. They'll think about scheduling, they'll think about buying, but they won't think about clicking on an ad, or being engrossed in a VSL funnel video.

Regardless of whether the action is **consciously** or **unconsciously** manifested, there are **heuristics** of the mind working in the background to dictate those decisions to act. If we understand these **heuristics** we can build better stimuli to **trigger** the **action** we want.

Lock and Key Theory 🗝️

The secret to building stimuli is to **leverage** the '**heuristics of the mind**'. There are a number of **heuristics** we can 'exploit' (ethically) and use to get what we want from humans.

The **heuristics** of the **mind** are like pins on a **lock**.

Imagine a **human mind** as a **lock** on a door. If you want to 'open' the door and get the action you want, you need to design a **key** that 'fits' the **lock 'pins'**.

Understand: The **lock** determines the **key**. The **key** does not determine the **lock**.

Understand: the **human** determines the **effectiveness** of the **stimuli**. The **effectiveness** of the **stimuli** does not determine the **human**.

Locksmiths design **locks**, then build the **key** afterwards, **in accordance** with the **lock** itself.

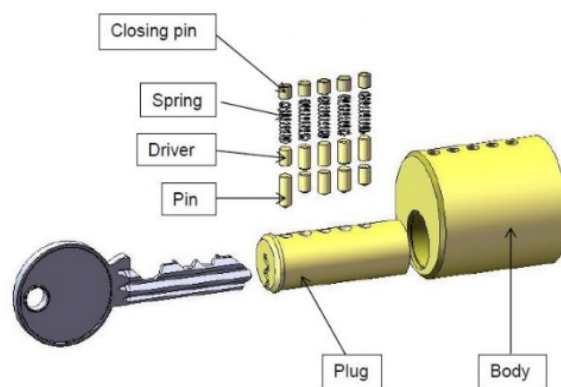
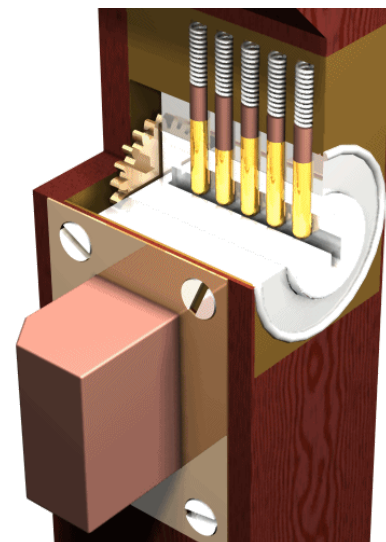
This is the fundamental paradigm shift you must have for ALL your stimuli. You must build your stimuli **in accordance** with the humans you are trying to reach out to.

There are **heuristics** about the mind we can understand. These **heuristics** allow us to predict how people will behave.

By understanding these **heuristics**, we can forge our **key** and increase the likelihood our **stimuli** have high **effectiveness**.

The better your **stimuli** fits the **lock** of the **human mind**, the more **effectiveness** it has.

Designing a **stimulus** without understanding the **human mind** you are designing it for is like designing a **key** without knowing what sort of **lock** you have to open.



Cognitive Heuristics (Cognitive Biases) 🧠 ⚖️

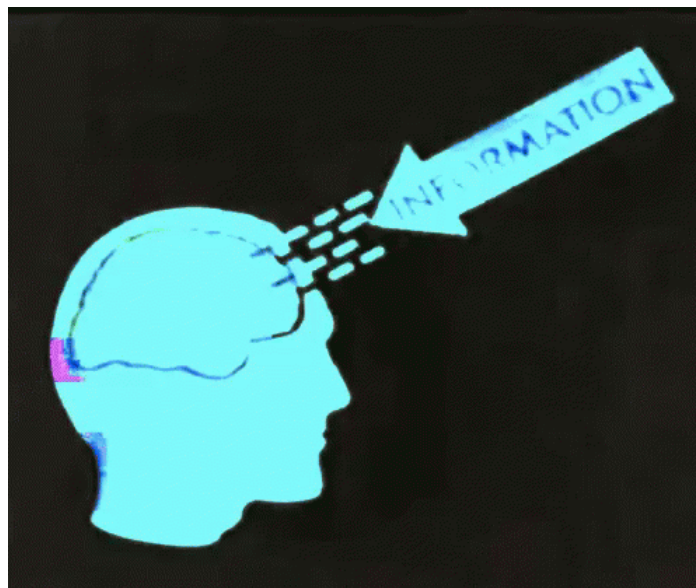
A **heuristic** (also known as a **cognitive bias**) is a pre-programmed 'quality' of the mind that processes information, typically in an irrational way (meaning the human does the action without thinking or reasoning, regardless of whether or not it's the right thing to do, or with slightly impaired judgement).

Heuristics are unconscious decision making tools and most people are completely unaware they have them.

You have **heuristics**, I have **heuristics**. Jeff Bezos has them, Elon Musk has them. Successful people have designed their heuristics for success, unsuccessful people haven't.

Information is received by the brain via the senses, such as touch, sight, smell, hearing, and taste.

All information received by a human is processed by the subconscious mind, which is riddled with **heuristics** & **cognitive biases**. These heuristics skew the information and bias the person's thinking towards an action.



There are a ton of universal **heuristics** we will be discussing in this video, but there are more **heuristics** unique to specific individuals, so we won't be able to cover every single one here.

For most people, **heuristics** are a force for **bad** (they create misjudgement and encourage irrational mistakes). However, you can use them as a force for **good**, by rewiring them. They're simply decision making tools. Every human is born with them, but if you want them to work for you, you need to become more aware of them and change yourself accordingly.

Think of **heuristics** in the mind like the **operating software** in a computer.

It's installed at assembly and all information is **computed** through it, meaning all information is 'biased' to the **operating software** and its **agenda**.



Example: *if the operating software is biased towards using adobe, all PDFs will be processed with adobe.*

Here's the cool part: we can **shape** and **forge** our stimuli to **fit** the mind by building it to take advantage of the **heuristics** shared by the human population.

Origin of Cognitive Heuristics 🧠⌚

To understand **heuristics** & **cognitive biases**, we need to understand why they exist.

The human brain has a large energy budget allocated by the body, in relation to its size. While accounting for 2% of your overall organic mass, your brain uses 20% of oxygen (and therefore calories) consumed by your body.

The brain requires some serious resources to run. What this means is that it LOVES efficiency. A more efficient brain = less caloric consumption = more energy = more survival. It's an evolutionary thing.

Also, a more efficient brain = smaller brain = smaller skull = smaller head = less chance of maternal mortality during childbirth. Once again, it's a survival thing. Nature has selected the human brain for efficiency.

Thinking, remembering & cognitive tasks are extremely expensive, calorifically speaking. Because of this, nature selected for cognitive shortcuts that prevent us having to think & therefore save expensive calories.

We know these shortcuts as heuristics. They were great when we were discovering fire, fighting snakes and sleeping in trees, when calories were scarce, but they're not so optimal for modern life.

You must understand that your brain (and everyone else's) is adapted for primitive survival. This means a lot of our cognitive tools, biases & heuristics would have been helpful to our ancestors surviving on the African plains 150,000 years ago. In fact, they're one of the reasons we are such a successful species (in terms of survival).

When you start reading about the common heuristics and recognising them in yourself and your own cognition, don't judge yourself for it. They kept your ancestors alive.

Examples:

Social proof: 150,000 years ago, if I saw caveman Bau running away from camp screaming 'ug ug ug' at full speed for no reason, it would likely contribute to my survival to follow suit, more often than not, so I'd run after him shouting 'ug ug ug'.

Reciprocity: if caveman Bau, with all his culinary talents, cooked too much meat and gave me some, it would be in my best interest to return the favour so we can make our mistakes profitable for ourselves in the future.



The Leverage List 💰📝

Serious ethical warning: We're now going to discuss heuristics of the mind that we can use to create confidence and trust to get people to take the actions we want them to take. It's important before we proceed that I have your awareness & agreement that with this knowledge comes a big responsibility. I'm trusting you to only use this module as a force for good. Please only use these if you know you can genuinely help people & are acting in their best interest.

—

Psychology sets the conditions for what an effective stimulus is.

Heuristics are leverageable. Understanding them helps you craft stimuli more conducive to action that a human otherwise wouldn't have taken had they not seen your stimuli.

I'm going to break down 88 heuristics. If you understand these and how they're interrelated, you will never struggle with effective stimulus creation.

Not much fancy colour here, sorry. Just raw fundamentals.

Note: these are models of behaviour and do not apply every time in a binary sense. Not all of them will exist in every scenario of human activity. They're not always relevant to acquisition. You don't need to bear every single one in mind when crafting stimuli.

1. Reward super-response tendency (incentives)

The main driver of human behaviour is incentive. An incentive exists as a force of motivation or encouragement for someone to do something, typically for their own interest. As Warren Buffet says, "the ants go where the sugar lies". People rarely do things without incentive.

Example: *your business's offer is the initial incentive that drives humans towards making decisions to become a client. The better the offer, the stronger the incentive, the more action you will get.*

2. Punishment super-response tendency

Humans don't like doing things that result in punishment. They avoid making decisions to take action to do things that will lead to them being punished (by a form of authority or not).

Example: *someone might not book an appointment with you because your offer doesn't contain enough risk reversal & they think by buying it, they will be punished with lost capital.*

3. Influence from mere association tendency

Humans are easily biased and influenced by association.

Example: *if you charge below all your competition, your prospect might associate your product with lower quality (since price is often associated with quality). Or, if your product is used by an authority in your niche, people will associate their success with your product.*

4. Liking loving tendency

Humans are more likely to act on something if they like or love the person asking them to act. They can also form their opinions and beliefs about reality based on who they look up to and like.

Example: *you're more likely to take advice from your parents than someone else's parents. Or, people will be more likely to buy from you if they like you or love you.*

5. Disliking hating tendency

Humans are less likely to act on something if they dislike or hate the person asking them to act. They can also form their opinions and beliefs about reality based on who they look down on and dislike.

Example: *if you hate Donald Trump, everything he says will be filtered through this hate, so even if he says something objectively true, you won't see it that way. Or, if someone hates your approach, they won't schedule to talk to you, even if you can change their life.*

6. Doubt avoidance tendency

Humans hate sitting with doubt, so make decisions to escape it. They will decide and act irrationally just to remove doubt and get out of a doubtful state.

Example: *if a prospect has doubts your service is worth their time, they will make the decision to not speak with you.*

7. Inconsistency avoidance tendency

Humans are biased towards not being inconsistent with identities, beliefs and paradigms. They are reluctant to act in a way that is misaligned with their worldview or self image.

Example: *if you get a prospect to intentionally schedule a call and remind them a few times of their decision to schedule, they're likely to show up as to not seem inconsistent with their prior action to schedule.*

8. Commitment consistency (confirmation) bias

Humans seek to confirm what they already believe to be true. They are biased towards seeking information that confirms their existing perception of reality, and reject that which doesn't align with their sense of reality.

Example: prospects who think Facebook ads are best for their business will naturally seek Facebook ads as a solution to their problems, even if YouTube ads are better objectively. Or, if you get someone who wants to think about it to pay a deposit, you skew them to buy later.

9. Curiosity tendency

Humans are curious and this drives their actions and decisions. They hate having half the picture and like to complete things (in cognitive and intellectual terms), so will typically act in accordance with this.

Example: if you have a website with every piece of information under the sun about your product, you sap most prospects of the natural curious motivation to schedule a call.

10. Kantian fairness tendency

Humans expect to be treated fairly and are extremely sensitive to a perceived lack of fairness in the world, especially if it concerns them or someone they love.

Example: if you have a prospect who works hard but doesn't make money, you can appeal to their Kantian fairness tendency by telling them they don't deserve to suffer like this, that it's not fair they don't have more and that you want to bring this fairness with your offer.

11. Excessive self regard

There is a strong tendency in the human condition to believe that one is better than others. They overestimate their abilities, skills, decision making abilities and objectivity.

Example: you have a prospect who says they've already tried everything that works. Because they tried it (and they are gods gift to the world), and it didn't work, it was the thing that didn't work, not their involvement in it.

12. Pain avoiding denial

Humans hate pain. To offset the feeling of pain, they often enter states of denial to warp their worldview to make things more bearable. This influences their ability to make rational decisions.

Example: *someone overestimates their ability to run their own Facebook ads, and the ads flop. But they declare the problem was with Facebook, not them.*

13. Overoptimism tendency

A lot of humans have a tendency to be overly optimistic with life. They expect better outcomes than are likely or rational, and overestimate how quickly they can get things they want.

Example: *prospects will expect results to be amazing as this is a natural tendency in human nature, so don't be afraid to write 'too good to be true' statements.*

14. Deprivation super-reaction tendency

Humans are loss averse. This means they react badly to losing things they have, and the negative emotional weight carried loss is net stronger than the positive emotional weight carried by gain.

Example: *people don't like losing opportunities to grow their business. If you position your offer as a get-it-or-lose-it-now type deal, you can leverage loss aversion.*

15. Social proof tendency

Humans have a tendency to base their actions and decisions on other humans' decisions and actions. If they see lots of people doing something, they're more likely to do it. Monkey see, monkey do.

Example: *on our website results page I wrote "340+ happy clients can't be wrong"*

16. Contrast misreaction tendency

People perceive things on a scale of contrast, always comparing something to its opposite to form a judgement.

Example: *\$1,000 seems expensive to pay for something when compared to \$45, but seems cheap when compared to \$1,000,000.*

17. Authority misinfluence tendency

People assign believability to authority, meaning they're more likely to make decisions, judgements and take actions because a figure of authority said it was the right thing to do.

Example: *I have a YouTube channel for this very reason. It gives me authority & makes my word carry more weight and influence. Alex Hormozi could tell his audience to eat a bowl of honey for breakfast for no reason, and they'd be inclined to do it because he has authority.*

18. Cognitive closure

Humans like closure. They like things to be in their place and proper, making decisions and taking actions sometimes just for the sake of closure, often preemptively without the right information.

Example: *someone makes a decision on a sales call before speaking with their business partner, because they wanted closure on the decision.*

19. Cognitive drift

It's common for people's belief systems to change over time and gradually. It can require a lot of evidence and persistent exposure to an idea for someone to adopt it as their own.

Example: *someone can believe a 1 call close isn't possible, but after enough exposure to the idea and evidence it works, their mind will change.*

20. Cognitive dissonance

Humans struggle with contradiction. They find it difficult and cognitively uncomfortable to hold two opposing viewpoints or beliefs in their mind. Decision and polarisation is a way to deal with this discomfort.

Example: *prospects seldom purchase from two vendors offering the same solution. Or, you might only want to run cold email or cold calling, not considering both at the same time is best.*

21. Familiarity bias

Humans are more likely to like, trust, love and believe things just because they are familiar. Familiarity is simply repeated exposure to something.

Example: *most of your cold email replies will come from follow-up 6+, because at that point, people have typically been exposed to you enough to feel familiar.. 'I kinda like this guy'*

22. The Ikea effect

People love things they build themselves, or ideas they arrive at on their own.

Example: *it's easy to fall in love with the stimuli and systems you create. You should only love what works in practice, not what you've developed in theory.*

23. Reciprocation tendency

People feel naturally obligated to other people who have previously done them a favour, or helped them. They're hardwired to give back, reciprocate & respond in kind to others.

Example: *you open up a payment plan to a prospect because 'you like them and it's a good fit'. They respond in kind by agreeing, feeling obliged to return the favour. By the way: this is why I never accept gifts from salespeople.*

24. Ben Franklin effect

We are more likely to like people who we have done favours for, and are more likely to do further favours for people we have done favours for before. We like helping people we've already helped.

Example: *you could email prospects the day before asking for a simple favour such as "can you do me a big favour and confirm this is the right email address?" to build this effect into your process, or you can remind people of the favours they've done prior to buying to get them to buy.*

25. Information bias

Most humans are naturally wired to seek information before making a decision, even when that information doesn't contribute to the knowledge they need to make the decision at hand. They are, by nature, information gatherers & squirrels for opportunities.

Example: *prospects may ask you for information prior to a call and then use this information to make prejudgements about your service, perhaps not even showing up.*

26. Action bias

Humans have a bias towards action. They'll often act on things they don't need to act on, or try to fix problems that don't exist. Even if action is not required, humans will have an urge to act.

Example: *because of this bias you can lean on it to encourage action. If someone replies to a cold email saying 'we're all set' you can respond with 'let's see if there are any small improvements we can make?'*

27. Non adaptive choice switching

Once bitten, twice shy. The inhibition of making decisions that seem similar in nature to previous outcomes that one has regretted experiencing.

Example: *including the word 'marketing' in your email copy immediately categorises you with every other marketing agency that has fucked over businesses before.*

28. Escalation of commitment

Also known as the sunk costs fallacy, this bias explains that people will escalate their commitment to something, even if it isn't the right thing to do. Essentially, it's doubling down on something, putting more resources into it, just because previous resources have gone into it.

Example: *if a prospect has spent 60 minutes on a sales call with you and still hasn't bought, they're more likely to spend an extra 15 because of the prior time expenditure.*

29. Hot-hand fallacy

A psychological condition in which people believe an individual is 'hot' or 'cold' depending on past performance, when that performance has no bearing on future outcomes.

Example: *if you can demonstrate to your client that 'you're on a roll' & that the latest 3/30 people to work with you got amazing results, you are leveraging the hot-hand fallacy (even if previous 27 people got bad results)*

30. Ambiguity effect

Humans try to avoid ambiguity and don't like the uncertainty it produces. They're less likely to act on things and make decisions that are ambiguous or produce ambiguity.

Example: *make your stimuli clear, straightforward and understandable.*

31. Status quo bias

Humans are biased towards conserving their current methodologies / ways of thinking & doing things. They are biased towards believing the status quo is the best way to go.

Example: *you can use words like 'traditional' and 'tried and tested' to give an indication your systems abide by the status quo, without seeming similar to everyone else*

32. Dunning-kruger effect

People who lack knowledge and skill commonly overestimate their competence, while people who have knowledge and skill commonly underestimate their competence.

Example: *recognise your prospect will likely be overestimating their ability to run their business and weave this into your stimuli with phrases like 'you know what to do', etc.*

33. Illusory truth effect

Humans tend to perceive claims or statements as truer if they have been previously exposed to them. This is why fake news can spread so quickly as truth.

Example: *if you want your prospect to believe your systems work, it helps to wrap this up into a certain claim or statement and expose them to it prior to their call. So, if I want prospects to believe we can make client acquisition easy, I'll spread it all over my stimuli.*

34. Rhyme as reason effect

Humans give more credence and believability to claims and statements that rhyme. A friend in need is a friend indeed, and an apple a day keeps the doctor away.

Example: *it might sound cheesy, but we really do make client acquisition easy.*

35. Subjective validation

People are likely to consider a claim or piece of information to be true or correct if it has personal meaning or significance to them.

Example: *if a piece of cold email copy explains the exact problems the prospect is facing, they're more likely to act on it because it validates their personal subjective struggle.*

36. Scarcity bias

Humans are biased towards acting to get things that are scarce, or seem scarce.

Example: *when we start a mastermind, we'll have a member cap & limit how many new people can join every quarter.*

37. Urgency bias

Humans are more likely to act now if they feel the action has urgency - meaning if it's not decided on or acted on now, there are going to be negative consequences.

Example: *this system won't work anywhere near as well in 6 months after "XX" updates their platform, so it's something we need to act on quickly otherwise we'll miss out on a huge opportunity.*

38. Click, whirr... conditioning

Humans have knee jerk responses that are conditioned into them. Most of their behaviour works like a machine, in a click, whirr... nature. This leads to irrational decisions.

Example: *if your copy looks like something everyone sends the prospect they will unconsciously categorise the copy as useless and knee-jerk response it into the deleted folder every time they see it.*

39. Reason respecting tendency

People are more likely to do something if they believe there is a reason for doing it. The reason doesn't even have to be that logical, it just has to exist.

Example: *including 'because _____' after your call to action in stimuli can contribute to better CTA performance, because we're giving a reason to move forward.*

40. Egocentric bias

Humans far too often rely solely on their own perspective to make decisions, and have high opinions of themselves that lead to them thinking they're always right.

Example: *if someone has the idea to not move forward with you, you cannot attack the idea directly as it's egocentric. Instead you need to use questions and empathy to bypass the ego.*

41. Anchoring bias

Humans have a tendency to rely too heavily on the first piece of information they learn, then comparing other things in the same category against that thing. Their judgement is easily impaired by a particular reference point or 'anchor'.

Example: *if Imperium sold a mastermind at \$100,000 but it's course at \$2,000, people would be more likely to think the course is in-expensive if first exposed to the mastermind.*

42. Availability mis-weighting tendency

If presented with two options, the average human will be more likely to pick the option that is most available. Humans typically default to the options that are most available to them.

Example: *the more follow ups you do & the more often you expose your calendly link to the prospect, the more available the link is for them to click. It's honestly this simple.*

43. Frequency illusion

After noticing something for the first time, there is a tendency for someone to notice it more often, leading them to conclude it's more common or has a higher frequency of occurrence.

Example: *if someone in your niche sees and believes one piece of social proof you have, they'll start seeing it everywhere (kinda like when you want to buy a certain type of car then start seeing it everywhere)*

44. Barnum effect

When individuals believe that personality / self image descriptions apply specifically to them, describe the fact the description is super vague and could be applied to anyone.

Example: *during the sales process, it helps to tell the prospective customer why they're such a good fit, and use their problems, situation & personality as justification for your confidence in the fit. Even if it's vague, e.g. 'we love working with hard workers', it's gonna work a charm.*

45. Zero risk bias

Humans have a tendency to seek to eliminate risk and pick the less risky option, even if the riskier option presents a better risk-reward ratio.

Example: *during a sales call, evergreen video, loom pitch or ad, position working with you as the less risky option, as opposed to the high risk option of them continuing to do what they're doing.*

46. Humour bias

Humans often act irrationally, picking things or deciding to do things because they are funny or make them laugh.

Example: *telling the odd joke in your stimuli, or saying something ironic, funny or downright hilarious can get people's attention and action from them. I use this in objection handling.*

47. Hyperbolic discounting

People are more inclined to make decisions and take actions that get smaller, immediate rewards instead of larger rewards later down the line.

Example: *position your offer in a way that can produce immediate gratification and results / rewards, while maintaining it's long term integrity.*

48. Ostrich effect

It's common for humans to bury their heads in the sand when trouble is brewing or they don't want to see the truth for what it is.

Example: *position your offer / service as a way for the prospect to bury their head in the sand, that they don't have to worry about it, that you've got it for them, etc. (you are the sand)*

49. Groupthink

Groupthink is a phenomenon that manifests when large groups or crowds of people get together and start thinking about things. It's extremely irrational.

Example: *people who run live 'free' seminars to sell their products often pay actors in the crowd to demonstrate extreme enthusiasm and get others swept up in groupthink.*

50. Recency effect

Things, ideas, statements, options & arguments that came last are remembered more clearly and with more prevalence than those that came first.

Example: *if a prospect is making a decision between you and four other vendors, make sure you're scheduled to talk to them after the other 4 vendors have pitched.*

51. Verbatim effect

People reduce conversations and complicated encounters down to simple understandings that are easily remembered, and then use these simple understandings, not the nuances of the complicated encounters, to make decisions (typically sub-optimal ones).

Example: *when pitching a prospect on a sales call, or writing a cold email, only include key details and differentiate between what is 'slightly important' and what is vital to understand.*

52. Envy / jealousy tendency

Humans get envious and jealous when they see other humans obtaining or maintaining things they desire or want. As Buffett says 'it's not greed that drives the world, but envy'.

Example: *if a business owner has friends crushing it, they will naturally envy their friends and want similar results - this is certainly leverageable if exposed during a sales process. Or, you can turn to an authority in their space they will naturally envy (and maybe hate) & promise to help beat that authority.*

53. Facial attention bias

Humans trust faces and their attention is biased towards images containing faces, typically those conveying emotion.

Example: *I use pictures of my face displaying strong emotions in my thumbnails to get clicks.*

54. First conclusion bias

Humans are biased towards the first idea they discover, often this limits their natural curious drives to explore alternatives. Part of the commitment consistency (confirmation) bias.

Example: *if you have multiple purchasing options available, make sure you explore the one you want them to pick the most first.*

Morgan's Heuristics

These are heuristics & biases that don't officially (academically) exist, but I've observed them and used them to sign nearly 1,000 clients. They're from my Observations (I didn't invent or discover all of these myself).

1. Permission-based mis-influence

Humans like perceived control in situations relevant to client acquisition. They're far more likely to agree to something or make a decision if the person making the request asks for their permission to ask in the first place. It's asking to ask. "Well, since you asked so nicely".

Example: *my favourite cold messaging opener revolves around asking them for their permission for me to pitch. This gives a false sense of control & makes them feel respected.*

2. Frame-based misreaction

Emotional states are contagious. In a conversation between prospect and salesperson, whoever is most persistent in their frame will win. A frame is an emotion state or viewpoint.

Example: *when on a sales call, if someone is talking with doubt, I WILL NEVER enter their frame and join them there. Instead I'll set my own frame of extreme confidence and stay in it until they join me. Either you buy their doubt or they buy your confidence.*

3. Psychological attrition tendency (persistence)

The threshold for action is decreased when persistence is applied. Children understand this: to get what they want they just won't stop asking. Shame we're conditioned to hold back on persistence as we grow into adults. It's a weapon.

Example: *I don't care how many rebuttals it takes, if I'm on a sales call and someone is a fit, I'll sit on the phone for 3 hours and stay persistent if I must. I also follow up on people a ridiculous amount of times and just don't go away. Never say 'this is my last followup'.*

4. Graduality tendency

Some decisions and actions require gradualness, meaning they start as unfathomable ideas that would never be acted on, and gradually become concepts that can be entertained, then become concrete and manifest into reality.

Example: *it once took me 11 months to sign a single client. On our first call, he said there's no way in hell he'd ever buy. As an experiment, I sent him a testimonial / result every month via email, personally. 11 months later he said 'alright you got me' (can be paired with attrition tendency).*

5. Simple digestibility (simple gets better results)

Humans are more likely to act on things that are easily understood. Simple words, simple images, simple stimuli, work better than over-complicated, messy ones. Just say what needs to be said and leave it at that.

Example: *when writing copy, try using words that are so simple & could be understood by a young child.*

6. Relatability bias

If a human can relate to someone, they're more vulnerable to influence from that person.

Example: *"I understand you want to know the price before buying, but if you had a prospect who was perfect for you, would you want to give them the price without any form of value to attach to it?"*

7. Understanding bias (if you understand they'll trust you more)

Humans that feel understood are immediately more likely to trust the person who understands them. "If she knows me this well, she must be able to help". Feeling understood is often synonymous with feeling trust.

Example: *during the objection part of a sales call, or if dealing with a thorny reply on cold email, I'll make an effort to truly put myself in their shoes and mirror their exact thoughts and emotional state back to them. This is a true fucking weapon.*

8. Originality bias

In client acquisition, humans are more likely to respond to initial stimuli if they are original. You don't need to get original with your calendly event or even sales questions, more so stimuli that is entry level to the system (cold email, cold message, ad creative, etc). Note: originality for the sake of originality won't work, it still needs to be effective elsewhere.

Example: *our original loom system works so well because it's original and hasn't been copied by 10,000 people.*

9. Creativity bias

In client acquisition, humans are more likely to respond to initial stimuli if they are creative. You don't need to get original with your calendly event or even sales questions, more so stimuli that is entry level to the system (cold email, cold message, ad creative, etc). Note: creativity for the sake of creativity won't work, it still needs to be effective elsewhere.

Example: *when following up with people, we use memes that are creative, funny (even if I do say so myself) and are unique to us.*

10. Live up to an expectation bias

Humans crave to live up to expectations set for them by other humans.

Example: *"I can tell you're the kind of person to act if you know it's right and makes sense"*

11. FOMO bias

Humans hate missing out on things, especially if other people around them are getting it.

Example: *"the last thing I'd want is for someone else to scoop this up who might be a worse fit than you"*

12. Disarming honesty bias

Nothing creates trust better than radical transparency & honesty. Honesty disarms the prospect of scepticism, because people who tell the truth are to be trusted. You can tell the truth then use the word 'but' to segway into a statement of believability.

Example: *"I can't get you 150 appointments a month unfortunately. But, if all you need is 20-30, that's something I truly can manage". Or "I know you wanna get to \$100k/mo in the next 90 days, but if I'm honest it's going to take us 12 months at least. I need to be honest with you about that, is that going to be OK?". "Can I tell you the truth, John?"*

13. Novelty bias (shiny object syndrome)

Humans are shiny object lovers. New things entice and excite them. Positioning your offer as NEW and SHINY and NEVER SEEN BEFORE thing can trigger action.

Example: *a lot of marketing agencies started selling tiktok ads as they were new and shiny. Or, position your service as 'something you'll have never seen or tried before, guaranteed'.*

14. Conviction bias (in sales)

Things stated with confidence are more believable to the average person, regardless of their efficacy or validity. If you want someone to share your confidence, you need to have it.

Example: *"this will completely change your life" is a pretty powerful statement, when stated with conviction.*

15. Casual bias (believing people who have casual conviction)

Professionals who are casual about their skills are often regarded as authoritative. Having a cool, collected tone when discussing how great you are & your offer is effective.

Example: *"yeah I mean, man, you need 20 appointments a month. That's 1 a day. That's literally nothing, we book 20 per day. Honestly you're gonna be so easy to please"*

16. Tried n' tested bias (oldschool tradition)

Often humans find trust and comfort in oldschool methods or 'tried and tested' strategies. If something is stated as proven, battle tested or 'rooted in undisputed and ancient method' it's more likely to be trusted.

Example: *Imperium relies on strategies and methods of thinking that are hundreds of years old and have stood the test of time. They worked then, and they work even better now.*

17. Selfishness tendency

Humans are selfish. If you want to persuade them, appeal to their interest, and not to reason. Most people only do things out of their own self interest.

Example: *if you do this you can keep it all to yourself and not share it with anyone else.*

18. Pattern break bias

Humans have inbuilt pattern recognition systems. They group certain stimuli into batches or categories and use these categories to make instant unconscious decisions of rejection.

Example: *how many times have you received a cold email only to delete it without even thinking? It's because the body copy looks similar to stuff you've unconsciously categorised as worthless or pointless.*

19. Mystery bias

Something shrouded in mystery creates interest and action to find out more.

Example: *if a prospect asks how it works, you can say 'good question, it's actually a bit of a secret but I'd be happy to share it with you on a demo'*

20. Politeness bias

Humans react well to people who treat them with respect and are nice to them. Please, thank you, you're the best, etc, goes a long way.

Example: *"thank you so much for your reply, it means a lot to me"*

21. Effort perception bias

Humans are more vulnerable to persuasion by someone who has put a lot of effort into their approach, or helping them.

Example: *this is why a simple Loom works so well. Even if you put no effort into it, it's the perception of effort that counts.*

22. Dramaqueen bias

Hyperbole is a great method to encourage action. It never hurts to exaggerate a persons problems and the effect those problems have. It never hurts to help them exaggerate their dream and your confidence.

Example: *if we don't fix this problem, it's the bloody end of the world as far as I'm concerned. Or, I am extremely, supercalifragilisticexpialidocious-ly confident we can solve this problem (that one isn't tested by the way).*

23. Disqualified identity bias

It often helps to disqualify people from your offer and explain who the service isn't for. By doing so you make the person more likely to think 'this is for me', especially if you understand them well.

Example: *this isn't for people who are looking for an easy, get rich quick sort of scheme. We want people who are committed for the long term and understand success takes time.*

24. Removed self-concerns bias

People often have concerns about their abilities or their identity / skillset, concerns that might hold them back from making decisions to move forward. Removing these concerns encourages decisions.

Example: *on our funnel it says 'you don't need to be an internet whizz, or a computer geek'*

25. Show n' tell bias

People believe what they see more readily than what they are told. If you want to prove a point, show them, don't tell them.

Example: *our reps don't tell prospects we can book 20 calls a day, they show them their calendars.*

26. Lil' bonus bias

Often the difference between someone acting and not is a tiny point that breaks the critical mass of their threshold.

Example: *oh, and one tiny extra thing if you're on the fence - if you book, I'll tell you my best (niche) related joke - it won't help your business but it should make you laugh.*

27. One of a kind bias

If people believe that they can only get what they need and want from you, they're going to buy from you.

Example: *"our product isn't like anything you will have seen before. You can't get this information and these results this quickly anywhere else" (then you need to back it up with why).*

28. Instruction clarity bias

Humans like clear instructions when making decisions. They like to know that, if they act and make the decision, that there is a clear cut path that gives them exactly what they want.

Example: *if someone is on the fence during a sales call, I'll ask them if it would be helpful to understand, in detail, the exact 6 steps we're taking with them to get them what they want.*

29. Exclusivity bias

Humans like acting on things that make that thing exclusively theirs.

Example: *if you work with us, we don't work with anyone directly in competition with you (only works for local businesses)*

30. Hard work bias

Humans (specifically business owners) overestimate their work ethic. This is leverageable.

Example: *I know you're a hard working business owner, and that's exactly why I want to work with you. One hard worker to another.*

31. Trend bias (don't get left behind)

Humans are likely to fall prey to trend bias if they think they can capitalise off the 'next big thing'. Mass trends are popular and encourage action.

Example: *"what we're doing is at the start of a big trend and I want to get you in early so you can have that early movers advantage"*.

32. Justification bias (why)

People like to understand why things work the way they do. If you state something, it helps to explain why you've stated it, or why you do it that way, or why you do it at all. (see also reason respecting tendency)

Example: *"the reason we do it like that is because it works better"*

33. Quantitative specificity bias

People are predisposed to believe numbers, quantitative values and statistics if they are seemingly specific.

Example: *"we've seen success with 83.3% of our clients"*

34. Overdone-it bias (used too much leverage in these biases)

Bias leverage can be taken too far. Sometimes it's best to fire parts of a stimulus from the hip without calculating every single part. If you are going to leverage biases you need to do it properly (you still need to seem like a genuine human).

Example: *ever read an ad that feels really slimy, or a funnel that doesn't feel natural at all?*

Reminders:

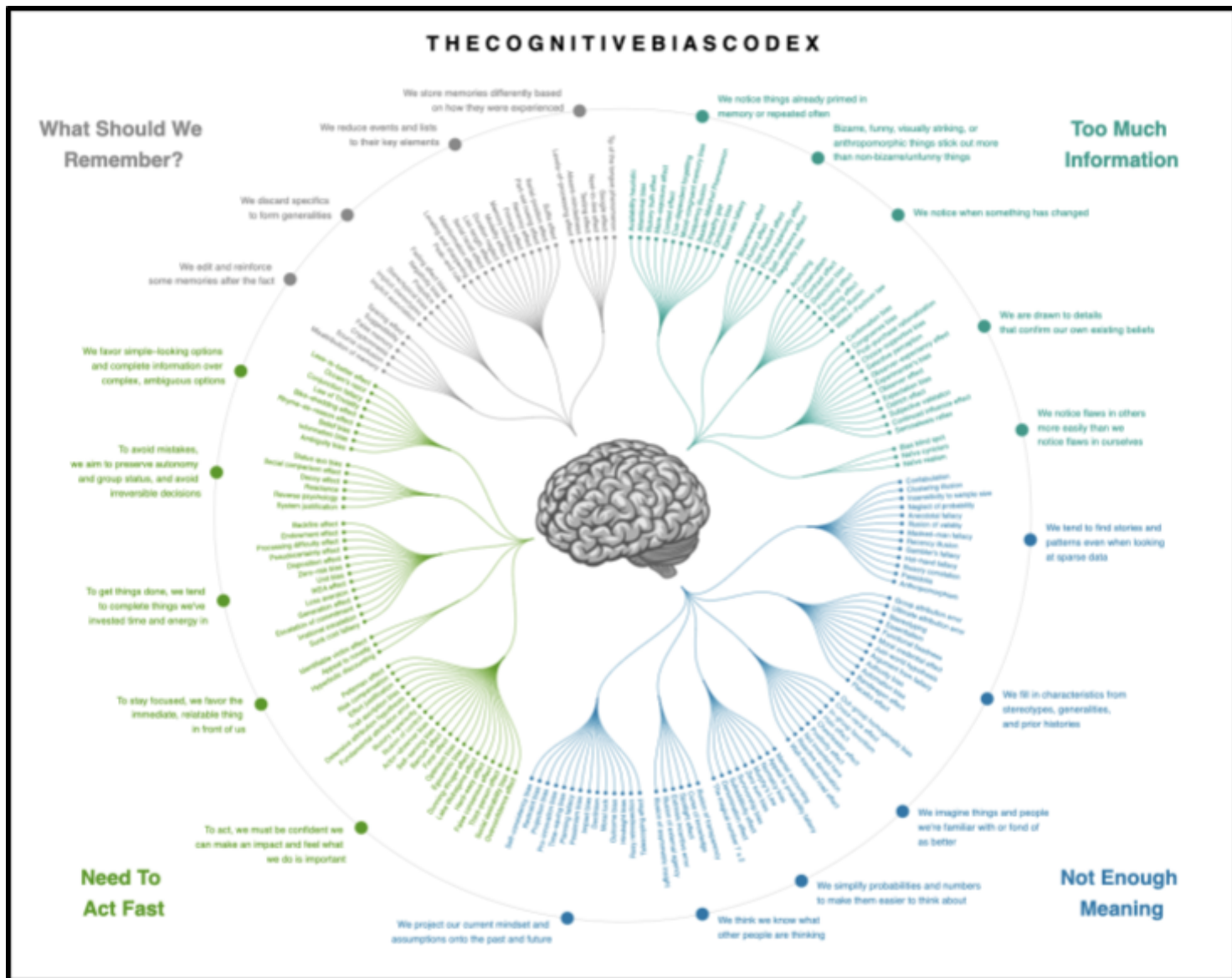
Serious ethical warning: We've discussed heuristics of the mind that we can use to create confidence and trust to get people to take the actions we want them to take. It's important before that I have your awareness & that with this knowledge comes a big responsibility. I'm trusting you to only use this module as a force for good. Please only use these if you know you can genuinely help people & are acting in their best interest.

Note: these are models of behaviour and do not apply every time in a binary sense. Not all of them will exist in every scenario of human activity. They're not always relevant to acquisition. You don't need to bear every single one in mind when crafting stimuli.

The Cognitive Bias Codex

In the resources there will be a .svg file that you can open to view the cognitive bias codex, credits to Wikipedia. It's fucking awesome.

Or you can view it by clicking [here](#).



The Lollapalooza Effect

The **Lollapalooza Effect** is a phenomenon that describes the **critical mass-like** nature of human decision making and action.

When you **combine** these **biases** into your stimuli, you can trigger (typically irrational) actions in humans that take them down your client acquisition process. **Irrational actions** are often **necessary**, so don't be afraid to conjure up irrationality in people you can help.

Often, the end decision to purchase is the sum result of the **combination** of many multiple **cognitive biases**, all **aggregated** to produce the decision.

With cognitive biases, (bias 1) + (bias 2) + (bias 3) does not equal an effectiveness score of 3. The **Lollapalooza Effect** is non-linear and unpredictable. 1 + 1 + 1 could equal 100, or 45 or 12,000.

This is a direct quote from Charlie Munger on cognitive biases and how they work in with the **Lollapalooza Effect**:

"The tendency to get extreme consequences from confluences of psychological tendencies acting in favour of a particular outcome"

"The most important thing to keep in mind is the idea that especially big forces often come out of these models. When several models combine, you get lollapalooza effects; this is when two, three, four or more forces are all operating in the same direction. And, frequently, you don't get simple additions. It's often like critical mass in physics where you get a nuclear explosion if you get to a certain point of mass - and you don't get anything much worth seeing if you don't reach the mass. Sometimes the forces just add like ordinary quantities and sometimes they combine on a breakpoint or critical mass"



Final Notes

Everything you need to know to craft, create and build effective stimuli can be found in this video. If you want to know how to write good copy, create brilliant sales scripts, or design funnels that work, you just need to understand people and how they think.

Influence goes deeper than whacking a few testimonials on a funnel and guaranteeing results. It's really deep.

Humans use heuristics to make decisions. A decision leads to an action, which is exactly what we want from the human in our client acquisition process. Design your stimuli with heuristics in mind to make your stimuli more effective at triggering action.

There's 88 heuristics in this video. Obviously I'm not recommending you use them all or start cramming all of them into everything you do. Be smart.

Summary

- Acquisition First Principles (Recap)  
- Stimulus Effectiveness  
- The Human Component  
- Lock and Key Theory  
- Cognitive Heuristics (Cognitive Biases)  
- Origin of Cognitive Heuristics  
- The Leverage List (54)  
- Morgan's Heuristics (34)  
- The Cognitive Bias Codex  
- The Lollapalooza Effect  

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